

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, morning fog, cooler, limited sun, a shower, high 64. **Tonight**, breezy, a shower, low 50. **Tomorrow**, morning showers, windy, high 59 early. Weather map is on Page B12.

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Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



BEIRUT, LEBANON The U.N. reported that 700,000 people were displaced in the country as Israel kept up its airstrikes on Tuesday.



TEHRAN A new billboard, left, showed the succession of supreme leaders. Right, lining up for bread after another night of bombing.



ARASH KHAMOOSHI FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

While Conflict Rages, Trump Has Few Tools To Ease Oil Price Spike

Paralyzed Strait Creating a Supply Shock

By BRAD PLUMER

WASHINGTON — As the war in Iran causes oil prices to surge and U.S. gasoline prices to rise, Trump administration officials are searching for ways to ease pain at the pump and fend off a voter backlash.

Yet American presidents have learned a tough lesson over and over since the 1970s. Once global oil prices start spiking, it can be difficult to shield people from the consequences.

Policy makers have discussed various ideas to reduce gasoline prices at home, including tapping strategic reserves, restricting U.S. exports and suspending gasoline taxes.

But unless the Iran conflict ends, quick fixes will likely be hard to come by.

“Those of us who have been through this before know there are no easy solutions,” said Bob McNally, a former energy adviser to President George W. Bush and now president of the research firm Rapidan Energy Group. As long as the war continues to disrupt energy supplies, he said, “the president has few effective tools to quickly bring down oil prices, and that’s just a reality.”

Oil prices have soared because fighting in and around Iran has paralyzed tanker traffic through the Strait of Hormuz, a narrow waterway off Iran’s southern coast that typically accommodates roughly 20 percent of the world’s oil supply and a large proportion of its natural gas. Since oil is traded globally, that shock has quickly translated to higher U.S. gasoline, diesel and jet fuel prices.

Until that tanker traffic returns to normal — either because the war ends or because Iran can no longer threaten ships — it will be difficult to bring prices back down significantly, experts said. And the longer the conflict lasts, the greater the risks that prices could soar higher.

“This is the largest supply shock in the history of the market,” said Rory Johnston, the founder of Commodity Context, an oil markets analytics firm. “Until normal traffic resumes through the strait, everything else is just tweaking around the edges.”

International crude prices have risen significantly since the conflict began, and were hovering around \$100 dollars per barrel for much of Monday until dropping below \$90 after President Trump told CBS News that the war is “very complete, pretty much.” Gasoline prices in the United States have climbed 19 percent, and by Tuesday the average was \$3.54 per gallon, the highest level since 2024.

Mr. Trump has been meeting with advisers to discuss ways to lower energy costs. Possible options could include waiving federal taxes or restricting U.S. fuel exports, analysts said.

So far, Trump administration officials have generally downplayed the severity of the oil shocks, saying that any disruptions will be temporary and promising that the conflict in Iran would be over soon.

“We’re putting an end to this threat once and for all, and the result will be lower oil and gas prices for American families,” Mr. Trump said on Monday.

If Iran continued to disrupt oil flows in the Strait of Hormuz, Mr.

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NEWS ANALYSIS

New Leader Takes On Office With Far-Reaching Grip on Iran

By NEIL MacFARQUHAR

In the political annals of the Islamic Republic of Iran, one of the first notorious public episodes involving Mojtaba Khamenei, the man just named as the country’s new supreme leader, occurred during the 2005 presidential election.

After a dark-horse candidate, Mahmoud Ahmadinejad, surged abruptly into a runoff and eventual victory, the reformist politician who unexpectedly lost wrote an open letter to the supreme leader accusing his son Mojtaba of manipulating the vote.

“You are well aware that the unwise intervention of the relatives and aides of some religious and political officials in the past has had a very negative consequence,” the opposition candidate, Mehdi Karroubi, wrote in the letter, published by two newspapers that were forced to suspend publication afterward.

Ever since, Mr. Khamenei has had the reputation of operating in the shadows, using the power of his father’s office to manipulate events in the Islamic republic in favor of the hard-line faction.

That headquarters of the supreme leader, which he is now

His Father Constructed a Secretive System to Wield Control

inheriting from his father, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, has always played an outside role in the country’s affairs.

In the 37 years that Ayatollah Khamenei ruled before being killed in an American and Israeli attack, he transformed the office from a traditional religious affairs bureau with a political cast into a national security juggernaut with oversight of the military, intelligence, the economy, foreign affairs and, of course, the clergy.

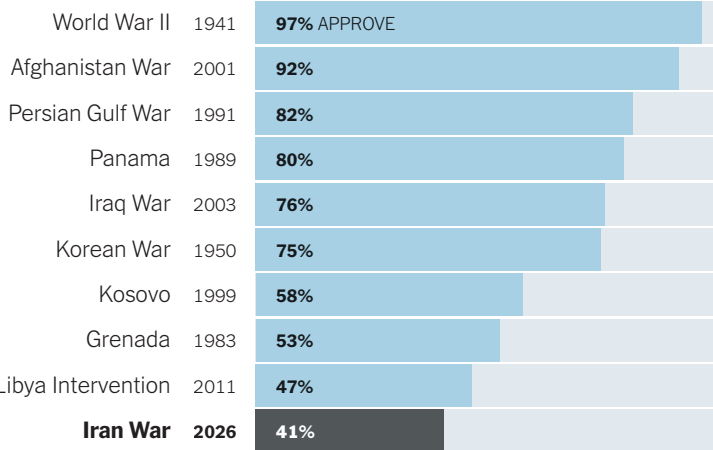
“Under Khamenei, it became a complete security, political and economic state within a state,” said Saeid Golkar, a political science professor at the University of Tennessee who was an author of a report this year about the transformation.

Mojtaba Khamenei, 56, the second of four sons, was already considered the “mini supreme leader,” advising his father on the office’s web of operations, Mr. Golkar added. His three brothers

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Less Rallying Around the Flag

Historical polling numbers show the conflict in Iran having significantly less initial support than past U.S. military interventions. Page A5.



Note: There is no polling on public approval of the Vietnam War at the start of the conflict. THE NEW YORK TIMES

The Bay Area Considers Life Without a Long-Distance Rail

By HEATHER KNIGHT and SOUMYA KARLAMANGLA

SAN FRANCISCO — As the sun peeked over the horizon on a recent Friday morning, only a few people stood on a platform in Pittsburg, Calif., to wait for a Bay Area Rapid Transit train that would whisk them nearly 40 miles southwest to San Francisco.

The working-class town with industrial roots sits on the edge of Suisun Bay and is known as a more affordable suburb. BART made it possible for Pittsburg residents to live in the farthest reaches of the Bay Area and avoid a cumbersome drive to San Francisco.

Seven years ago, BART trains would fill up quickly each weekday, with passengers taking every seat, jostling for space in the aisles and clutching every pole. Now, the trains often lumber into the city with a trickle of commuters rather than a crush.

BART’s future is dire. Its ridership cratered during the pandemic and remains less than half of what it once was. And the very future of the familiar white and blue trains, which have zipped around the Bay Area since 1972, is in doubt.

BART directors say that only Bay Area residents can rescue the system by passing a new sales tax in November. Absent that, the board recently warned that it would take eye-popping actions out of desperation in 2027.

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Dressed for Paris
A model on Saturday near the Métro on the Quai des Célestins. During Paris Fashion Week, designers played with slimmer silhouettes and buoyant looks, moving past the era of quiet luxury.

An iPad in Kindergarten Class? Timeout, Say Worried Parents.

By JACKIE MADER

A few months before her daughter started kindergarten, Claire Benoist saw a Facebook post that stunned her. Another family with an incoming kindergartner was wondering if it was true that children in the Croton-Harmon School District, 40 miles north of New York City, receive iPads when they start school.

Other parents confirmed that during school, kindergartners often used iPads to play games and watch television shows and YouTube videos. School administrators assured Ms. Benoist that iPad time would be limited to 15 minutes a day, she said. But once school started, her daughter suddenly knew jingles from the diaper and car commercials that would play before YouTube videos she saw in the classroom.

“I don’t understand how we’ve created a system that fosters this kind of screen time in school,” Ms. Benoist said.

There is mounting evidence that excessive screen time can harm young children — contributing to anxiety and depression, delaying social and emotional skills, increasing the likelihood of obesity, straining eyes and decreasing attention spans.

In response, many parents are cutting back on device use at home. But some families are encountering an unexpected challenge as they try to rein in screen

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The Suburb That Won’t Sleep
Food is bringing thousands of people together to an unexpected place: a plaza west of Toronto. PAGE A4

A Look at Nepal’s Next Leader
Balendra Shah’s party won a landslide in the election that followed a Gen Z revolution. His style is pugnacious. PAGE A9



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Deported Despite Purple Heart
Sae Joon Park, an Army veteran who was forced to leave the U.S. over a criminal history he thought he had atoned for, is fighting to return to Hawaii. PAGE A10

Abuse by Physician Overlooked
Two doctors tied to Columbia and New York-Presbyterian resigned in the wake of a report on Robert Hadden. PAGE A14

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The Messi Experience
Field invaders in Puerto Rico, a war briefing in the White House — just another week for Inter Miami. PAGE B8

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A Soaring Night at the Met
The soprano Lise Davidsen and the director Yuval Sharon showed how a new generation might stake its claim to opera’s core repertoire. PAGE C1

Happy to Play His Part
In the comedy “Shrinking,” the actor Ted McGinley has finally found a job in which he feels fully appreciated. PAGE C1

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Revealer of Nixon Tapes
Alexander P. Butterfield testified to the existence of a secret recording system in the Oval Office. He was 99. PAGE A19

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Less Reaching for the Sun
After President Trump’s attacks on clean energy, the number of new solar installations fell by 14 percent. PAGE B1

Returning Nike to Sports
The company’s C.E.O. is meeting with leagues, teams and athletes around the globe to rebuild connections. PAGE B1



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Abuse Claims Against Star Chef
Former employees of the Copenhagen restaurant Noma said René Redzepi mistreated staff members. PAGE D1

Hot Dogs and Sled Dogs
Iditarod spectators gather along the route with grills and thermoses to celebrate the 1,000-mile race. PAGE D1

OPINION A20-21

Bret Stephens PAGE A21

